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ENCINO ENTERPRISE

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NEWS IN BRIEF

ONEgeneration to Host Annual Touch a Truck Event Sept. 20

ONEgeneration will be hosting their family-friendly "Touch a Truck" event on Saturday, September 20, from 8 am to 12 pm at 17400 Victory Blvd. See, touch, and hear different types of vehicles! Climb in a dump truck, run the sirens on a police car and lift the hose of a fire truck. This interactive event has all of the vehicles with a function for essential work that kids see and wonder about. There will be a sensitivity hour with no sirens from 8 to 9 am. Plus, free children's activities like bubbles, face painting and crafts. Tickets are $15 for adults and $10 for children with all proceeds benefitting ONEgeneration. Buy them at zeffy.com/en-US/ticketing/touch-a-truck-september-2025-onegeneration-family-event-in-encino.

Encino Neighborhood Council to Host Harvest Moon Movie Night

Fall is in the air and the Encino Neighborhood Council is celebrating the Harvest Moon with a movie night on Saturday, September 20, from 5:30 to 9 pm at Encino Park (16953 Ventura Blvd.) There will be face painting, free ice cream, free popcorn and a showing of the classic Speilberg film E.T. Bring your own blankets and low chairs. This free community event is also sponsored by Councilmember Raman and Assemblymember Gabriel.

Red Barn Tarzana Closing; Will Become Metro Storage

The Red Barn Feed & Saddlery at 18601 Oxnard Street, a fixture in the Tarzana community since the 1950's, will close its doors November 1. Owned by Phil Carter from the 1980's until his passing in 2023, Red Barn was a community hub where families could visit, pets could be pampered and animal lovers could connect. The new owners chose not to renew their lease and will close the store.

Metro will re-purpose the property to support their facilities maintenance operations, including work on the G Line Bus Rapid Transit, and the future East San Fernando Valley Light Rail Transit, currently under construction on Van Nuys Blvd.

Encino Community Zoom Let Locals Vent About Crime, Homelessness, and the Controversial SB79

Over 150 locals congregated on a Zoom meeting last night to discuss an array of pressing issues facing Encino. While increasing crime and security have been the major focus over the past few months, this meeting's focus largely centered on the divisive bill, SB79. This bill permits multi-family, high-rise residential buildings to be built in single-family residential neighborhoods within a half mile of transit corridors despite any previously established zoning laws. (See related editorial on page 4.)

The conversation, moderated by Encino Property Owners Association President Rob Glushon, got the most heated when arguing the potential detrimental effects if the bill is signed. Councilmember Nithya Raman, the featured guest speaker of the meeting, voted against the City Council resolution to veto the bill. (It is also worth noting that State Senator Henry Stern voted no, Mayor Bass voted no and Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel of Encino declined to vote.)

In response to why she chose to vote as she did, Raman explained, "My vote was to engage with SB79. It puts us at a disadvantage point if we veto against it because we have a housing crisis and we need to build more affordable housing in Los Angeles. It's important to engage with the bill's goals." As the majority of the Zoom attendees were residents of these potentially affected neighborhoods, the pushback was strong. After a testy back-and-forth, Glushon closed the topic by pronouncing, "You're voting how you want and not representing us."



Things got heated between EPOA Glushon and Raman when discussing SB79 on last night's Zoom.

In the remaining time, Councilmember Raman and LAPD Senior Lead Officer Tim Walia gave various updates on crime and answered questions from participants, many of whom are still outraged at the current state of local matters including homelessness, traffic concerns and the increasing fires in Sepulveda Basin.

General platitudes, calls to reach out to local government officials and requests for follow-ups were generously sprinkled throughout the conversation by Raman.

Before disclosing the local crime stats, Walia confirmed that a large Hispanic crew responsible for multiple home burglaries throughout the Valley had been arrested on September 11 in the Westlake Sherwood area. Additionally, Walia warned that there is currently a known "distraction team" going around local shops and diverting customers' attentions to then steal items from women's purses. He urged everyone to not leave their purses in open sight, such as a shopping cart, and hold them close to the body instead.

He disclosed that the current crime statistics for August were as follows: zero homicides, one rape, four burglaries (down from July, which had 30), six aggravated assaults, five motor vehicle thefts, 16 vehicle break-ins and 35 thefts.

In regards to homelessness, Raman assured the attendees that her team is being aggressive in addressing the problem in Encino. With an established group solely dedicated to the homeless, their office knows the locations of various camps and knows the majority of the unhoused individuals by name who they are trying to get off the street in a sustainable manner.

One local inquired about the potential problems that may arise from the Oak Tree Inn being converted into a shelter site. Raman went on to explain that the site is intended for 18 to 24-year-olds transitioning out of the foster system, many of whom are either in school or working. The site consists of 26 rooms, each individual has their own case manager working with them and the property is monitored by 24-hour security.

The discussion of Oak Tree Inn sparked a heated discussion on the homelessness crisis in the area and the true cost of handling the issue.

(continued to page 3)

CALENDAR





Community Calendar

* The Encino Neighborhood Council will be holding their monthly general board meeting on Wednesday, September 24, at 7 pm. For details and agenda, visit encinonc.org.

* The Sherman Oaks Encino Chamber of Commerce will be hosting their Mix & Mingle Live on Tuesday, September 30, from 5:30 to 7:30 pm at Granville (11136 Magnolia Blvd.) in North Hollywood. The cost is $20 for members and $40 for guests. RSVP at shermanoaksencinochamber.org.

* Join the West Valley Regional Library each Monday at 10 am for their World Literature Book Club. The short story selections are from *100 Great Short Stories* edited by James Daley and *The Scribner Anthology of Contemporary Short Fiction*. This month's selected works are as follows: September 22: *The Caretaker* by Anthony Doerr and September 29: *We Didn't* by Stuart Dybek.

* You can experience a crystal healing sound bath at the Native Spirit Lodge in relaxing reclining chairs. No yoga mats! The body's main energy centers are associated with specific musical notes and frequencies which can be utilized in sound healing practices such as sound baths. These notes and frequencies are believed to resonate with and balance the corresponding chakra, influencing physical, emotional and spiritual well-being. Sound baths are held daily in a specially dedicated room. For more information, call (818)-703-7046.

* United Chambers of Commerce will host their annual "State of the City" Mayors Luncheon on Tuesday, September 30. Confirmed participants include Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass, Calabasas Mayor Peter Kraut, Burbank Mayor Nikki Perez and San Fernando City Mayor Mary Mendoza. The event will be held at the Warner Center Marriott. Tickets are $100 for chamber members; $125 for non-members. Register at unitedchambers.org.

* Celebrate Dia de los Muertos at the Encino Tarzana Library on Saturday, September 27, at 4 pm. Each participant will receive one terracotta pot to paint in the Dia de los Muertos art style. Seating is limited and tickets for the event will be given out on Saturday, September 27 starting at 3:30 pm.

* The San Fernando Valley Audubon Society will host Dana Stangel of Teranga Ranch on Thursday, September 25, from 6:30 to 8:15 pm at the Encino Community Center (4935 Balboa Blvd). Teranga Ranch is a wildlife education organization that teaches people about local wildlife and how to coexist with them. This hybrid meeting (in-person and on Zoom) will start at 7 pm, with a question and answer period after. If you want to attend by Zoom, RSVP at sfvaudubon.org/event/in-person-zoom-event-neighborhood-wildlife.

* ONEgeneration's community partner, LA Compost will be at the Encino Farmers' Market on Sunday, September 21, from 8 am to 1 pm for a quarterly compost distribution. The team will be sharing free small bags of nutrient-rich finished compost, available while supplies last. No RSVP is required.





People in the News





Local author **Geanna Culbertson** is getting into the spirit of spooky season with the recent release of her YA novel, *Hallowed*.

This two-part autumn-awesome fantasy celebrates the magic of Halloween with plenty of adventure, a touch of romance, and positive themes like taking fate into your own hands, self-love, and balance. Though it has spooktacular suspense, this story breaks free from the habitual hard-horror focus of Halloween content to provide a fresh addition to the season that younger and adult audiences can both enjoy.

As heir to the fall-tastic kingdom of October, Eve has been learning to embrace her powers of light and shadow, and fight evil phantoms her entire life. But when the shrewd son of a noble family overthrows her parents with the aid of Vampire hybrids, her realm is thrust into danger. With the help of her monster friends, sassy ghost sidekick, and a Ghost Hunting web series on Earth, Eve must overcome the insecurity haunting her to save her world and find the true magic of Halloween.

Culbertson is a proud alumna of the University of Southern California where she earned her B.A. in Public Relations and triple minor degrees in Marketing, Cinematic Arts, and Critical Approaches to Leadership.

She is the award-winning author of *The Crisanta Knight* series, the fantastical guardian angels series *Heaven't You Heard?* and the critically-acclaimed Christmas novel *The Present*.

Hallowed (parts one and two) can be purchased through Amazon.com, BarnesandNoble.com and through the author's website at culbertsonkingdom.com.

English Channel



By Rodger Sterling

English Channel offers the best of the late editor Rodger Sterling's columns that ran continuously in the local papers since 1968.

• So many sayings we use every day come from the Bard. These are some of our favorites from dear old Shakespeare:

- Fight fire with fire.
- Wear your heart on your sleeve.
- Makes your hair stand on end.
- Set your teeth on edge.

And believe it or not, Knock knock! Who's there?

• Jerry Humes wants to know:

- Why do we press harder on a remote control when we know the batteries are dead?
- Why doesn't Tarzan have a beard?
- Why do Kamikaze pilots wear helmets?
- Why does Superman stop bullets with his chest, but ducks when you throw a revolver at him?

and...Why, if people evolved from apes, are there still apes?

• Thought for the day. A sharp nose indicates curiosity. A flattened nose indicates too much curiosity!

• We like this definition: Restaurant chains are cook-alikes.

Encino Community Zoom Cont'd

(continued from page 1)

Roy Nwaisser, President of the Encino Neighborhood Council, shared that the cost of Oak Tree Inn was $10,700,100, which amounts to $411,543 per unit. In response to that, Glushon asked Raman if the problem with homelessness in the area is really due to a lack of money or a lack of control over how it's being spent to address the issue?

Raman shared that local homeless services cost less than a billion dollars a year, so the people of Los Angeles need to accept a larger shelter budget. The current budget only tackles shelter costs and not related costs such as hygiene, mental health services, etc. She stressed that over 40% of calls for the LAPD are related to homelessness. If they can reduce the number of unsheltered, they can reduce the number of 911 calls and the LAPD can put more of their focus on crime.

At almost two hours, the Zoom allowed locals to air their grievances, but no concrete answers were ever truly given. General platitudes, calls to reach out to local government officials and requests for follow-ups were generously sprinkled throughout the conversation by Raman.

Before departing, Raman stressed, "It's a tough time to be an elected official here in Los Angeles. We have significant loss of federal funds that are deepening and worsening a budget crisis that is partially external and partially self- made."

Those interested in future community meetings and local Encino updates can sign up for newsletters at encinopoa.com, encinonc.org or cd4.lacity.gov.

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Guest Editorial: SB 79: a Seven to Nine Story Apartment Building Next Door to YOU

By Ken Ross

Senate Bill 79 is now on Governor Gavin Newsom's desk, after just being approved by the State Senate. Amazingly, a single day before that, it was approved by a single vote in the State Assembly. If the Governor approves it, it will become state law and start inflicting pain in the Southland extremely rapidly.

Too bad that very, very few homeowners even know how their lives may be horrifically changed with its passage. Those I spoke with don't believe that it's possible to even imagine such a law. They said they would be shocked to look out their kitchen windows and find a seven- to nine- story apartment building blocking their view. Just how ruinous would that be to San Fernando Valley neighborhoods?

Well, just look what happened around the Coliseum and USC to those formerly lovely old neighborhoods. The erection of numerous multi-story apartment buildings instantly created traffic and parking nightmares. Pity those poor homeowners whose property values depreciated and will continue to tank. Or just maybe... YOU should be worried that YOU might be the next poor homeowner to be pitied?

What do you think that would do to YOUR property value if a five- to nine-story apartment building popped up next door, seemingly overnight? Well, guess what? When your next-door neighbor is offered 50% more than market value for her/his single-family dwelling, what do you think they will do? That's right. They will take the money and run, leaving you and your neighbors "holding the bag."

Oh, and before construction even starts, as soon as the word gets out (in a flash), you think your home will sell for even half the going rate? That same contractor will not need to pay more than the depreciated value to build more monstrosities in your neighborhood.

This can't really be happening, right? It just doesn't make any sense. How could any reasonable person possibly want to destroy the American Dream of owning a home in a single-family neighborhood? Well, if you are a half mile from a bus transit stop, then lucky you, you actually will qualify for a next-door apartment monstrosity. And it WILL HAPPEN if/when our beloved Governor signs SB 79 into law in the next few weeks. We know that Katie Porter, who is running for governor, supports it along with State Senator Wiener, the bill's author. State Senator Suzette Marinez Valladares also proudly said she favored its passage, but they aren't the only state senators (and assembly persons before them) who created this nightmare for homeowners all across California.

How could any reasonable person possibly want to destroy the American Dream of owning a home in a single-family neighborhood?

So, if this bill is so horrible for homeowners, why does it have any support? Well, in case you missed it, there is a real affordable housing shortage all over California. So, here's a get rich quick opportunity for developers who might appear to be solving the problem. While every new apartment building will house a small number of fortunate people, it unfortunately won't put a dent in our homelessness problem. Instead, they are creating an unbelievable problem for those neighborhoods directly affected (and also the surrounding ones) that will suffer parking and over-crowding issues instantaneously.

Apparently, Senator Wiener didn't think it was important to include demands for greatly increased parking for every new apartment to be erected. Also, the SB 79 supporters, the self-named YIMBIES (i.e. "Yes In My Backyard") don't REALLY want one of these abominations next door to them. The more accurate name should be 'yiYbies" (i.e." yes in YOUR backyard'). Would a single YIMBIE really want a new next-door multi-story apartment building that had no allowance for more neighborhood parking?

Fortunately, CD 12 Councilmember John Lee has taken the lead on opposing SB 79. On August 20, he reported "Yesterday, the LA City Council passed the resolution I introduced to formally oppose this bill. But the power still rests with State Legislators, and they need to hear from YOU." So, while we appreciate the City Council support, please understand that it's ONLY Governor Newsom who now has the power to pass or veto SB 79.

Elections have consequences, so you may want to take note of who voted for and against this measure. Also, those without an actual vote may be staking their political futures on their own public pronouncements on this issue. For example, it's going to be a tough call if you like Katie Porter but can't stomach her support of SB 79. She probably won't be the only one to cause your head scratching.

For example, if Governor Newsom actually signs SB 79 into law, does that propel him into the White House in 2028? Hmmmm, perhaps a more likely outcome is that it ticks off homeowners all over California. And then he finds himself surrounded by outraged homeowners every time he delivers a campaign speech. So, would a tagline of "Nine-Story Newsom" perhaps derail a presidential run? Who knows? Maybe only a couple hundred protesters show up at each campaign rally.

That would be horrible for so many Democrats who are dreaming that Governor Newsom will actually become president. They envision him as the guiding light that could restore American (small "d") democracy and uphold the U.S. Constitution. I sincerely hope he turns out to be a great guy who has the decency and intelligence to veto this darned bill. Only time will tell. However, if any elected official can't oppose this obvious horror show for homeowners, are they going to really understand our future needs? Or will they pass more crazy laws to harm us irrevocably?

Be thoughtful, be democratic, be of ken.

Ken Ross sits on the Northridge East Neighborhood Council, where he has been both Second Vice President and First Vice President.

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When Rebrands Backfire: The Cracker Barrel Lesson

By Miri Rossitto

Rebranding is never just about a new logo. It's about recalibrating how a company presents itself in the market and to its customers. Done right, it sharpens relevance, builds loyalty, and drives growth. On the other hand, when done wrong, it erodes trust and alienates the very people who built the brand in the first place.

In August 2025, Cracker Barrel became the latest case study in how not to execute a rebrand. Under the new CEO, Julie Masino, the company invested nearly $700 million in a modernization strategy aimed at attracting younger audiences. On paper, it was smart. In practice, it was a cultural landmine.

Within days of unveiling a simplified logo and "All the More" campaign, loyal customers revolted. They didn't see modernization. They saw betrayal. Shares fell, headlines mocked, and the brand was forced into a hasty retreat.

The lesson is clear: nostalgia isn't fluff. Nostalgia is equity; once erased, it is expensive to rebuild.

Where Cracker Barrel Went Wrong

Cracker Barrel wasn't wrong to pursue modernization. Stagnating sales and an aging customer base are real business problems. The remodels, refreshed menus, and digital-friendly logo were, in theory, sound moves.

But here's the misstep: The company underestimated the emotional weight of its heritage. By stripping away Uncle Herschel and the iconic barrel, leadership removed more than imagery. They erased symbols tied to decades of family rituals, road trips, and comfort.

Customers didn't just dislike the new look. They felt abandoned. A YouGov poll revealed 76% preferred the old logo. Online conversations spiraled into political debates, turning the rebrand into a cultural flashpoint. Instead of sparking loyalty, the rebrand fractured it.

The Takeaways for Business Leaders

Cracker Barrel's stumble offers a playbook of "what not to do" and timeless lessons for leaders considering a brand refresh.

Start With Strategy, Not Cosmetics: A logo is not a strategy. Before you touch fonts or colors, define the business problem you're solving. If you can't articulate the purpose in one sentence, you're not ready.

Audit What Already Works: Not everything is broken. Some symbols, stories, and traditions carry deep equity. Keep what works and change the clutter.

Anchor in Your Core Values: A rebrand should feel like you, only clearer. If employees or customers don't recognize the brand after the shift, you've gone too far.

Pressure-Test With Loyal Customers: Your most loyal audience isn't a barrier to change. They're your compass. If they feel excluded, no amount of sleek design will save you.

Communicate the Why: Silence invites people to write their own stories. Explain the change, frame it as evolution, and pay homage to the past.

The Hidden Cost of Missteps

Rebranding is expensive, far beyond design fees. It touches signage, packaging, websites, training, and culture. For Cracker Barrel, the price tag wasn't just the $700 million investment. It was nearly $100 million in market value erased in days, and, more damaging, a loss of trust.

Because once nostalgia bites back, the cost is far greater than a new logo.

When customers tie emotion to your imagery and rituals, those are not expendable assets. They are the cornerstone of loyalty.

But not all rebrands fail. Utilized effectively, it can:

Renew energy across teams and customers.

Differentiate the company in crowded markets.

Expand reach to new audiences and partners.

Build long-term adaptability and relevance.

The difference? Execution rooted in empathy. Starbucks didn't throw away its siren; it evolved her. That's the golden rule: protect the DNA, evolve the expression.

Cracker Barrel's story is a cautionary tale. The need for change was real. The strategy was logical. But by mishandling the emotional core of its brand, leadership turned modernization into alienation.

For leaders, the takeaway is simple: A successful rebrand feels new, relevant, familiar, and authentic. It's not a personality transplant. It's an evolution.

If you're asking whether it's time for your brand to evolve, you're already in the right conversation. The next step is not guessing; it's knowing. Test. Listen. And above all, fiercely protect the equity you've earned. Because once nostalgia bites back, the cost is far greater than a new logo.





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Legislation Passes Strengthening Penalties for Impersonationing First Responders During Emergencies

The California State Legislature recently passed a pair of bipartisan bills to provide law enforcement with better tools to crack down on looting and impersonation of emergency personnel during wildfires and other emergencies. Not only is it grossly unethical, it impedes the health and safety of the community.

Crimes like these endanger both the public and the first responders dedicated to protecting them.

In the months following the devastating Southern California fires, impacted communities have been victimized further by widespread looting. Directly following the fires, law enforcement arrested dozens of individuals for looting and impersonation-related charges, including two individuals from Oregon charged with impersonating firefighters in the Palisades Fire evacuation zone.

These actions pose significant risks to public safety and undermine evacuation efforts, leading to confusion and potentially deterring residents from following critical public safety guidance. Crimes like these endanger both the public and the first responders dedicated to protecting them.

"Individuals who put our firefighters at risk and prey on communities when they are at their most vulnerable must be held accountable. Looters – particularly those who impersonate emergency personnel – create chaos and confusion, endanger residents and first responders, undermine public trust in evacuation orders, divert critical emergency resources, and victimize communities that already have suffered unimaginable harm. I am proud to join efforts with my Senate and Assembly colleagues to provide law enforcement with better tools to crack down on looting and impersonation, and I urge Governor Newsom to sign these important bills," said Assemblymember Gabriel.

AB 468 and SB 571 now head to Governor Gavin Newsom's desk, where they must be signed into law or vetoed by October 12.

TIMING IS EVERYTHING.

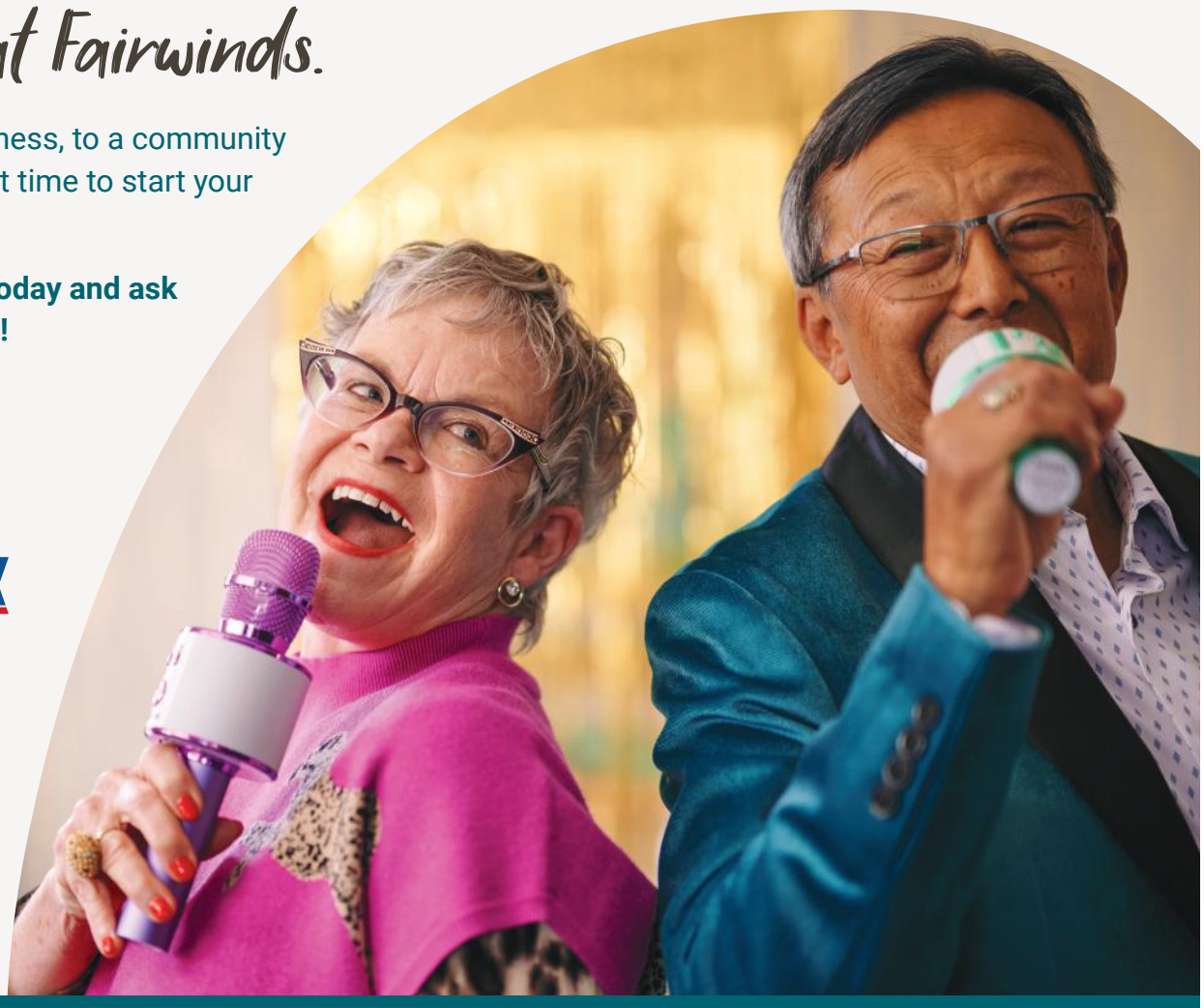
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HEALTH



Council Adopts Motion to Reduce 911 Call Wait Times

Local council recently adopted legislation to reform the 911 emergency response system in LA, as brought forth in a motion introduced earlier this year by Councilmember Nithya Raman, and seconded by Councilmember John Lee.

The City is currently experiencing ongoing challenges in its 911 system, resulting in some emergency and non-urgent calls not being answered within an acceptable timeframe. Councilmember Raman's legislation seeks to improve wait times through several avenues including hiring additional Police Service Representatives (PSRs) dedicated to exclusively handle non-emergency calls and exploring the creation of a separate non-emergency call line.

Addressing long wait times for 911 calls is extremely important. It can be destabilizing and traumatic when the city does not pick up the phone when you need help, whether in an emergency or for non-urgent issues. State standards mandate that the City answer 90% of all 911 calls within 15 seconds. In Los Angeles, as of 2024, 57% of emergency calls were addressed in 15 seconds or less, and wait times for non-urgent calls are even longer – in extreme cases, up to an hour.

Due in part to low recruitment for open positions for 911 operators, emergency and non-emergency calls are currently being routed through the same operators. Councilmember Raman's legislation outlines several options the City should explore to address this issue, including assessing the feasibility of establishing dedicated non-emergency operators within the LAPD's Communications Division to enhance service efficiency and exploring the creation of a separate, dedicated non-emergency line housed within the city or externally contracted that is tasked with dispatching unarmed crisis response teams, filing reports, and providing other non-emergency assistance.

City standards mandate that the City answer 90% of all 911 calls within 15 seconds. In 2024, 57% of calls were addressed in 15 seconds or less.

"Reforming our 911 call system is essential to this city getting serious about public safety," said Raman.

Councilmember Raman's legislation requests the Chief Legislative Analyst (CLA) and LAPD, in consultation with the Mayor's Office of Community Safety to report back within 30 days with recommendations to improve 911 call times for both emergency and non-emergency calls for service.



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The Reel History of the Valley

By Martin M. Cooper

Don't Expect Perfection

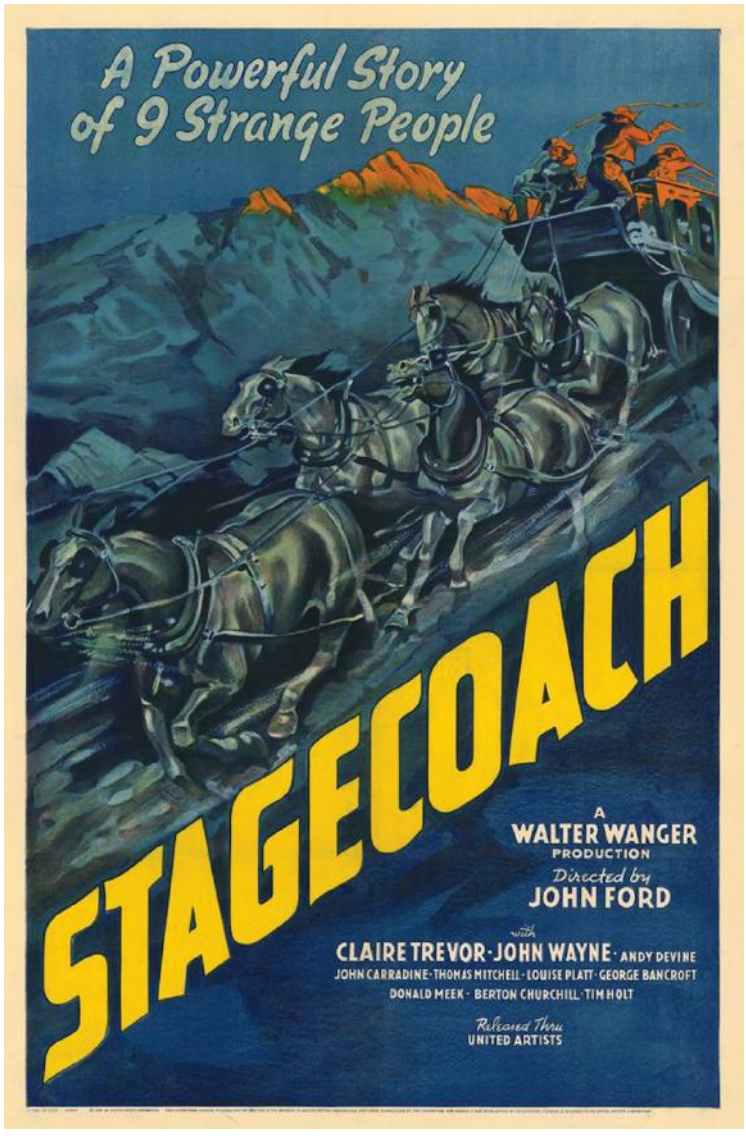
San Fernando Valley-based writer Paul Pumpian has a theory about films: If you really enjoyed a movie, don't see it more than twice. In his cinematic catechism, if you do, you're sure to see the flaws or continuity issues you missed in the first two viewings, and that will diminish your love for that film.

Every film lover knows the complexities of filmmaking, the time frames (often months) over which they are shot, and the hundreds of people (onscreen and off) who are involved, make bloopers or other errors nearly inevitable. But that doesn't diminish the fun in spotting them.

Take, for example, 1939's *Stagecoach*, one of the best Westerns ever, and shot partially on the Iverson Ranch in Calabasas and the RKO Studio Ranch in Encino. According to Pumpian, "Before the film's gun fight conclusion, there are two occasions where the travelers pull into resting places; in both, the stand-in stagecoach driver is a much thinner man than the much-more-portly Andy Devine, who drives the stage throughout the film.

"In *Stagecoach* there's a great deal of drinking, but not once is alcohol paid for. The boozy doctor is in the town saloon when he gets a free drink from the bartender. When the stagecoach is at its second rest stop, there is more drinking, but no paying. The same is true at the film's final saloon scene, where the villain and the doctor down shots."

Finally, Pumpian points out, during the classic chase scene, several of the Indians ride alongside the stagecoach without shooting arrows into the horses, an act that would have ended the chase. The first arrow that hit Donald Meek was an incredible shot, because the sound of the approaching Indians was still far behind the coach when it nailed him.



Western movies don't get much better than 1939's Stagecoach, directed by John Ford

Pumpian's second example is that classic, *The Treasure of the Sierra Madre* (1948), also partially filmed on the Iverson Ranch, as well as the Warner Bros. Burbank lot: "To disguise their intent of searching for gold, the three men head into the Sierra Madre on the pretext of being hunters, armed primarily with pistols. You can't do much successful hunting with pistols, but at the film's conclusion, the trio has amazingly accumulated numerous bundles of animal fur.

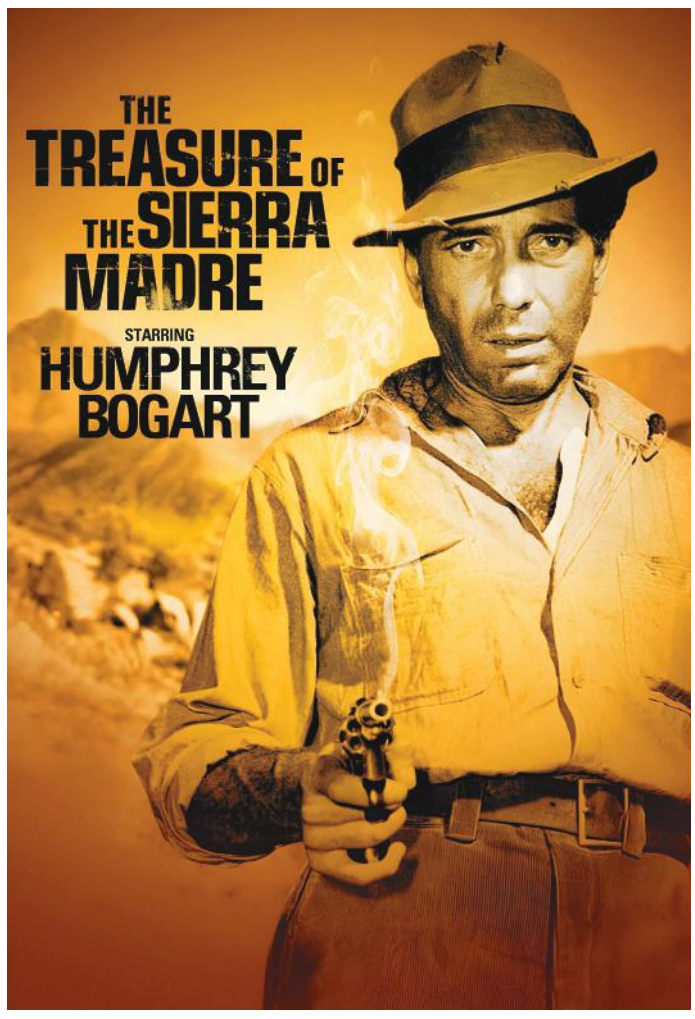
"Gold Hat's sombrero is missing the bullet hole that Bogart shot into it at the mountain confrontation previously. During the cantina fight with McCormick, the position of Dobbs' hat on the bar rail changes at least twice.

"When Howard is laid on a hammock, being served by Indian women, he has a little bunch of flowers on his left ear which disappear in subsequent shots."

Pirates of the Caribbean: The Curse of the Black Pearl (2003) was partially filmed on two Valley studio lots, Disney and Universal. The keen-eyed will spot a number of "goofs," as IMBb.com calls them. When Barbossa is shouting commands while chasing the Interceptor, in one shot his teeth are perfectly white, while in the rest of the movie they are decayed.

When Will Turner first shows up in the movie bringing the sword to Governor Swann, Turner is almost clean shaven; in the next scene, which occurs on the same day, he has a little goatee and almost full mustache.

Early in the film, when Jack Sparrow is standing on the sail of his sinking boat, he prepares to step onto the dock by raising and extending his right foot. The next shot shows his left foot taking the first step.



Humphrey Bogart starred in the classic The Treasure of the Sierra Madre (1948). In the film, his only weapon was a pistol, but he was portrayed as bagging lots of game.

During a shot of Jack Sparrow at the helm, the keen-eyed will spot a crew member in a T-shirt and cowboy hat at the far edge of the frame.

A fourth example is *Harry Potter and the Chamber of Secrets* (2002). Much of the film was shot at Warner Bros.' studio in Leavesden, England.

The errors are nearly too numerous to recount. For example, when the bludger hits Harry's hand in the Quidditch scene, his arm guard is shown flying off his arm; the next time his arm is shown, the arm guard is still there.

While Harry and Draco are dueling, a camera operator is clearly reflected in the glass behind them. In another dueling scene, Professor Lockhart is knocked backwards by Professor Snape's charm, and his wand can be seen flying through the air. When he lands, however, the wand is still in his hand.

Nearly every film has these miscues or other issues. However, I'd still watch *Stagecoach, The Treasure of the Sierra Madre, Pirates of the Caribbean: The Curse of the Black Pearl*, and *Harry Potter and the Chamber of Secrets,* any time they show up on the large screen, because these are films too "big" to be viewed on an in-home monitor, no matter how large.

Martin Cooper of Cooper Communications supervised public relations for the Academy of Motion Picture Arts & Sciences for 10 years.

His next book, The 'Reel' Hollywood: The San Fernando Valley, the history of motion pictures in the Valley, will be out later this year.

ENTERTAINMENT

New Quiltillion Store Offers Everything for Colorful Quilting

What does a creative type do when he returns to his hometown village? Open a store that's perfect for a cozy hometown village!

That's what Jon Russikoff has done in the Old Granada Hills Village. His new store, Quiltillion, deals with everything for the old-fashioned, - yet now super-trendy - hobby of quilting.

"I want this to be a place to share my understanding of color, good tools and good design," Russikoff said. "I want to create a quilting community here in my own community. I love to teach, and everyone is welcome!"

Quiltillion caters to everyone from a novice to an experienced quilter. "In my beginning class you don't need a sewing machine. You don't need to have ever cut a piece of fabric. You don't need anything except an eye for color. You can use all the tools of the store to get started," he explained.

Showcasing Russikoff's love of color, the shelves are stocked with bolts of fabrics, offering different tonals, textures and blends.

All sorts of tools and notions are available, including patterns, sewing accessories, ironing accessories, scissors and even true left-handed scissors.

For experienced quilters Quiltillion offers longarm services and custom quilts.

The store is located at 17537 Chatsworth Street in the heart of the Old Granada Hills Village. It is open Tuesday through Saturday 10 am to 5 pm, Sunday 12 noon to 4 pm and closed Monday. For more information call (818) 488-1011, email info@quiltillion.com, or visit quiltillion.com.



Owner Jon Russikoff

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Soraya Announces 2025-26 Season

The 2025-26 season of The Soraya at CSUN journeys farther than any previous: the nightlife of Lisbon, Buenos Aires, and Mexico City; the daily life of West Africa; the spiritual realms of Alice Coltrane and Duke Ellington; the masterworks of Brahms and the megahits of Quincy Jones; and much more. There is something for everyone and every family member from children to adults.

Tickets are now on sale for all concerts, but the best way to embark on this journey is with a Soraya membership. In addition to yearlong benefits and optimal flexibility, membership offers an insider's view into the art and artists, adding depth and dimension to the journey throughout the season.

The Fall schedule kicked off with *Fiddler on the Roof*, and continues with the CSUN Dept of Music - The Arturo Sandoval Story on Wednesday, September 24 and Mariachi Herencia de Mexico on Friday, September 26.

The dance company Graham 100 – with special Centennial creation by Bernstein, Rountree and Boykin featuring Wild Up takes the stage Saturday, October 4.

Disney and Pixar's *Toy Story* screens Saturday and Sunday, October 11 and 12. Fly Me to the Moon – tribute to Quincy Jones plays Saturday, October 18.

Lila Downs Dia de Muertos shows Friday, October 24, with the Colburn Orchestra playing Sunday, October 26.

Ray Chen Onstage is already sold out for Thursday, October 30, but Mariza is on stage Thursday, November 6.

Saturday, November 15, Ballet BC Bolero X dances on to the stage while Momix Alice is the featured performer Saturday, November 22.


Graham 100 dances onto the stage October 4.

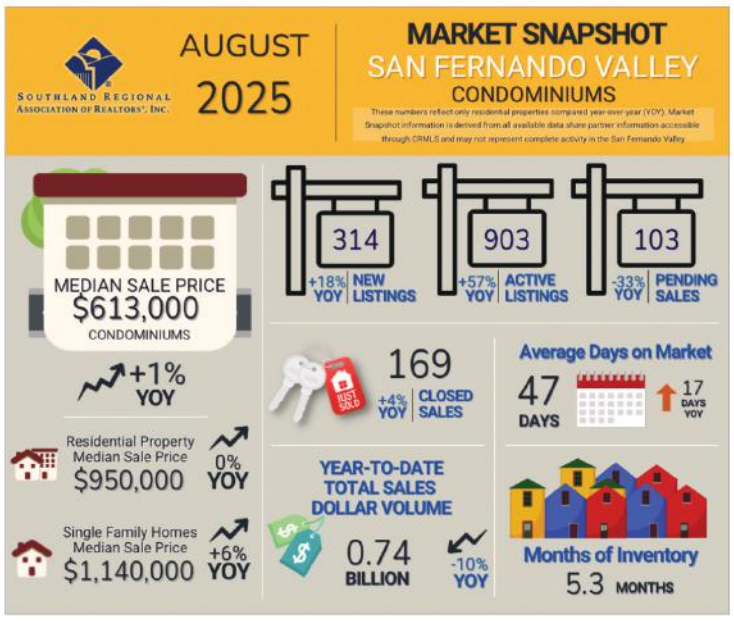
Gregory Porter Christmas Wish kicks off the holiday season on Saturday, December 6, while The Klezmatics Happy Joyous Hanukkah bring their sound Sunday, December 7.

The Christian Sands Quartet is on stage Friday and Saturday, December 12 and 13, while Nochebuena: A Christmas Spectacular closes out the year Saturday, Sunday and Monday, December 20, 21 and 22.

The Chicago Symphony Orchestra performs Thursday, January 22 and then the Jazz at Naz series begins February 1.

The Soraya is located at 18111 Nordhoff Street on the campus of CSUN. For tickets visit thesoraya.org, call (818) 677-3000 or email thesoraya@csun.edu.

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Valley Condominium Listings Hit a Six-Year High in August

Condominium active listings in the San Fernando Valley during August soared to the highest level in six years while condo closed escrows posted the first increase in seven months, the Southland Regional Association of REALTORS® reported recently.

There were 2,940 single-family home and condo active listings combined at the end of August, an increase of 20.6% compared to August 2024. That was down slightly from the last two months which were the highest tallies in 14 years.

While new listings of homes fell 12% to 798, condo new listings increased 20% to 318.

The combined total also represented a 4.6-month supply at the current pace of sales, just shy of the 38-year average monthly supply of 5.3 months – which is viewed as indicative of a balanced market. For comparison, the monthly supply averaged 2.6 months from 2019 through 2024.

"Our members report that they are seeing fewer multiple offers and an increase in the time a property lingers on the market," said Anthony Bedgood, President of the 10,000-member Southland Regional Association of REALTORS®. "With a swelling inventory, sales typically also would increase, but some prospective buyers are hesitant because of the pervasive uncertainty clouding the home resale market and the national economy."

"Yet the increase in condo sales during August also means other folks who want to own a home see an opportunity, appreciate a wider selection, and jump at the added bargaining power," Bedgood said.

Local REALTORS® assisted the close of escrow of 169 condominiums last month, an increase of 3.7%. It was the first time since December that condo sales rose compared to the prior year.

The association also reported 465 single-family closed escrows, a decline of 19.3% from August 2024.

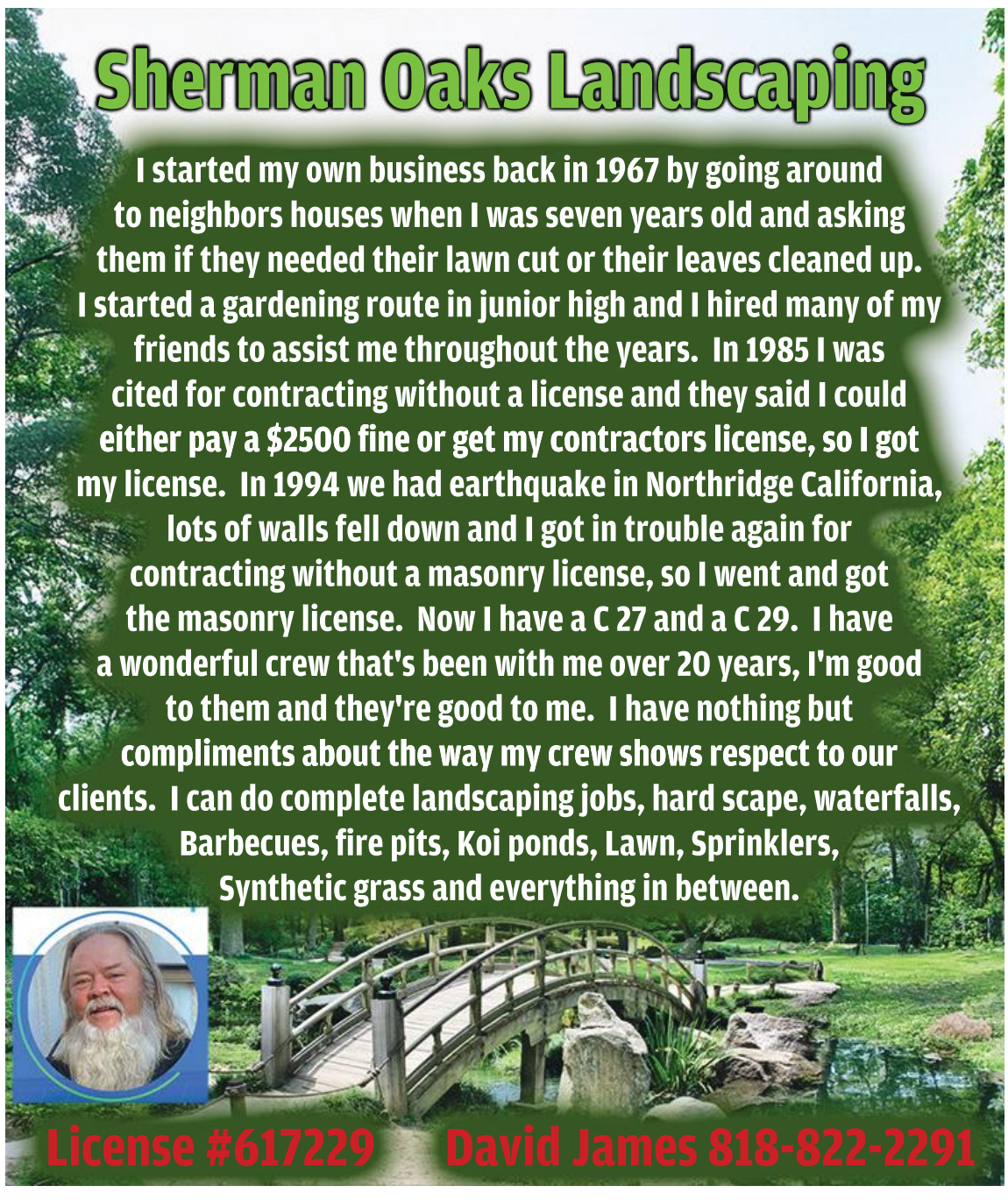
"A big dose of market certainty along with possible cuts in the interest rate for home loans could provide enough of a boost to pick up the pace of sales as the year draws to a close," said Valerie Biletsky, the Association's Chief Executive Officer. "At the moment, however, certainty seems elusive."

The median price of the 645 homes that changed owners last month was $1,140,000, up 6.5 percent from a year ago though down from the record high $1,150,000 set in June. The condominium median price of $613,000 increased 1.3% compared to a year ago. The record high of $660,000 was set in July 2024.

SRAR's Income-to-Loan guide for August calculated an income of $300,492 was needed to qualify for an 80% loan of $912,000 on a San Fernando Valley median-priced single-family home of $1,140,000. With the national average interest rate at 6.83% last month, the income needed to qualify was up 5.6% from a year ago. The monthly PITI — principal, interest, taxes and insurance payments — totaled $7,512.

Chartered by the National Association of REALTORS® in 1920, the Southland Regional Association of REALTORS® is the voice for real estate in San Fernando and Santa Clarita Valleys. With 10,000 members, SRAR serves as a trusted resource and partner to the real estate profession and the community at large. SRAR local market statistics are compiled from all available data share partner information accessible through CRMLS and may not represent complete activity for the San Fernando and Santa Clarita Valleys.

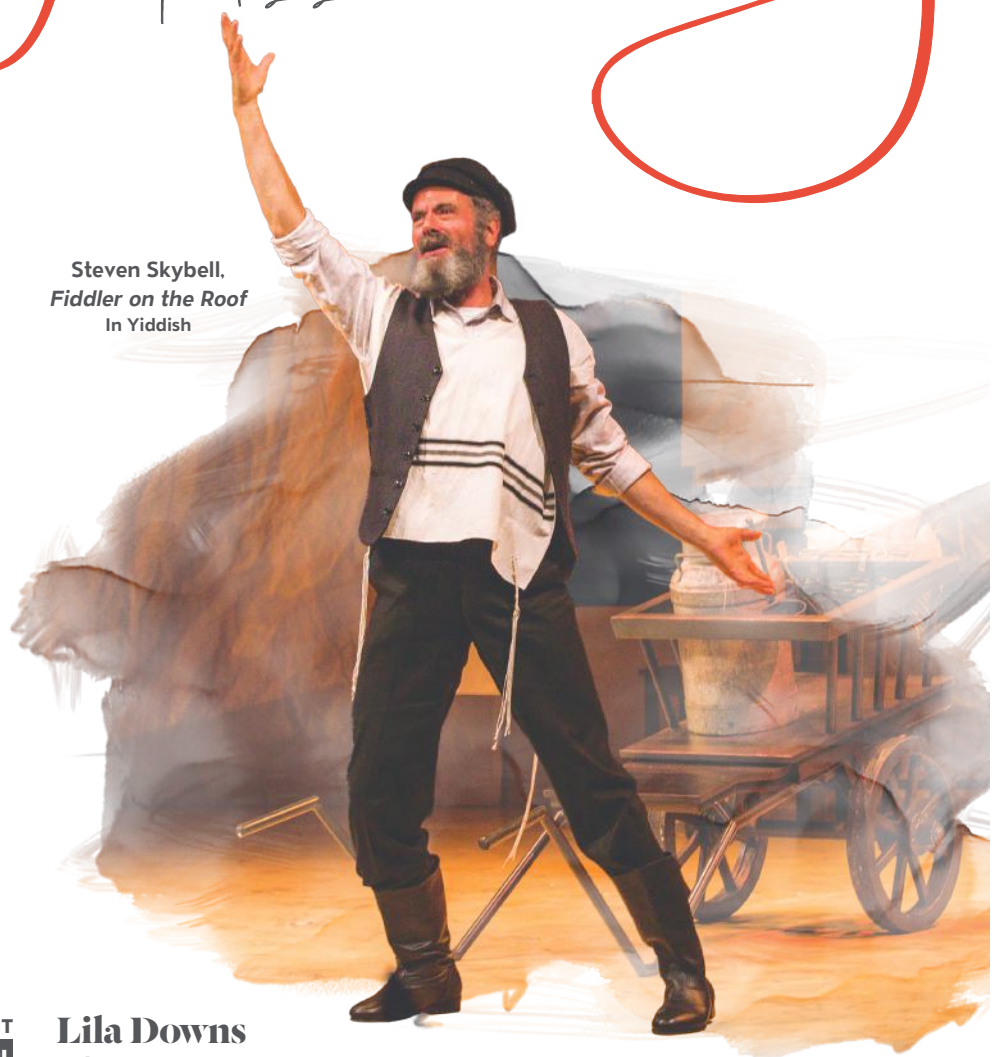




15 THE SORAYA

Journey

Fall 2025



Steven Skybell,
Fiddler on the Roof
In Yiddish

SAT SEP 13 8PM
SUN SEP 14 3PM 7PM

National Yiddish Theatre Folksbiene's
Fiddler on the Roof
in Yiddish
A Soraya Concert Production
and West Coast Premiere
With English Supertitles

Opening Weekend

FRI SEP 26 8PM

Mariachi Herencia de México
With Special Guest Leonardo Aguilar

Graham100
The Martha Graham Dance Company's 100th Season
With a Special Centennial Creation by
Bernstein, Rountree, and Boykin
Featuring Wild Up

SAT OCT 4 8PM

SAT OCT 11 3PM
SUN OCT 12 3PM

Disney and Pixar's
Toy Story
30th Anniversary
Live-to-Film Concert

Fly Me to the Moon
A Tribute to Quincy Jones
Featuring Pacific Jazz Orchestra
With Special Guests
Ms. Lisa Fischer and José James
Chris Walden, conductor

SAT OCT 18 8PM

FRI OCT 24 8PM

Lila Downs
Día de Muertos

SUN OCT 26 3PM

Colburn Orchestra
Carlos Miguel Prieto, conductor
Zi Yang Low, violin

SCAN FOR TICKETS



Lila Downs

THU NOV 6 8PM

Mariza

SAT NOV 15 8PM

Ballet BC
BOLERO X

SAT NOV 22 3PM

MOMIX
Alice



Mariza

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